

FROM REVOLUTION TO FRIVOLITY

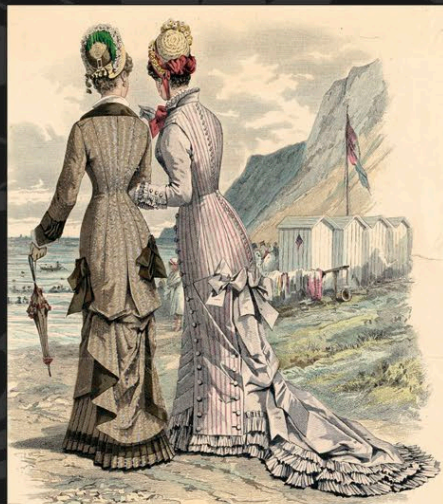
This was a century of unprecedented and accelerated change. The world's population grew dramatically, and infant mortality was reduced by a quarter due to improved healthcare and hygiene. The average adult lifespan increased by a decade, and a burgeoning middle class acquired property and possessions, patronized department stores, and indulged in sporting activities. Day trippers to national exhibitions and the seaside saw fashionable society men and women at leisure and aspired to their lifestyle – and fashions. Philanthropic reforms, including educational provision, assisted the working classes in seeking to better themselves by working their way up in factories, shops, or “in service”. The world was changing rapidly, and the increase in members of the affluent middle classes breathed life into the market for fashionable garments.

On the move

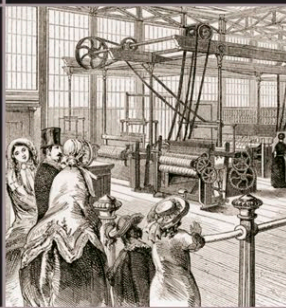
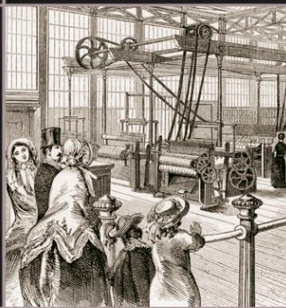
After the Industrial Revolution, there was a major shift from country to town dwelling. Improved transport systems – railways, steamships, roads, and bridges – supported trade and allowed ordinary people to travel greater distances. Increased mobility expanded their range of experiences and gave rise to a new sense of worldliness and fashion consciousness. The efficient circulation of newspapers and the advent of postal delivery, as well as photography, the typewriter, telephone, and transatlantic telegraph facilitated long-distance communications. News of national, European, and American politics travelled at greater speed. Fashion information, through magazines and correspondence, could now be readily shared between continents. Fashion was becoming truly international.

A new age

Rapidly evolving politics, economics, technology, and new discoveries impacted on fashion. Pride in national heroes in Britain spawned the Wellington boot, named after the Duke of Wellington, and the Gladstone bag after Prime Minister William Gladstone. Mechanization of textile processes enabled ever more complex weaves and prints at more affordable prices. A revolution in the home came with the domestic sewing machine, and piped water, which aided daily washing; most people above the breadline now owned and wore more garments than ever before.



SEASIDE ELEGANCE
Two elegantly dressed women; a colour plate in *The Englishwoman's Domestic Magazine*, January 1875.

1790–1800	1801–10	1811–30	
1790 The fashion for “dandyism” emerges, championed by socialite Beau Brummell.  ▲ Beau Brummell in his “daytime ensemble”	 ▲ Napoleon's profile on a coin	1811 Jane Austen's first novel <i>Sense and Sensibility</i> is published, and another five novels follow, two of them the year after her death in 1817. A social commentator, Austen's novels include acute observation of her characters' clothes.  ▼ Portrait of Jane Austen	
	1804 Napoleon Bonaparte is crowned. During his reign, he puts France at the forefront of fashion innovation and design. 		
	1806 <i>La Belle Assemblée</i> , a British women's magazine, is published for the first time and includes features on fashion.  ▲ Early model of a sewing machine	1815 After the Duke of Wellington defeats Napoleon Bonaparte at the Battle of Waterloo, Wellington boots become a popular fashion item.  ▼ Mechanized plush loom	
1790 The first design patent for a sewing machine is granted. Within 50 years they are produced and start to be used in factories.  ▲ Early model of a sewing machine	c.1810 British-born Edward Cartwright had patented the first power loom in 1785, but the design was in need of modification. Between then and the early 19th century it underwent improvements and by 1820 was commonly used in both Britain and the US. 		
1795 Waistlines are raised, paving the way for the development of the empire silhouette and the unabashed neoclassicism of late 1790s fashion.  ▲ Early model of a sewing machine			